

what it is!

Napoleon Hill passed away in November 1970 after a long and successful career writing, teaching, and lecturing about the principles of success. His work stands as a monument to individual achievement and is the cornerstone of modern motivation. His book, *Think and Grow Rich*, is the all time best-seller in the field.

Perhaps no other success book has influenced more people than Napoleon Hill's Classic *Think and Grow Rich*. Since it's introduction in 1937, millions of copies have been sold around the world. It still remains one of the top selling books of its kind.

Several years ago I came across a biography of Hill on a PBS show and it was an eye-opening adventure into the life of a man whose days were not the smooth sailing I had always assumed they were.

Napoleon struggled against a myriad of obstacles throughout his life many of which were brought on by some of the earlier choices he had made. I can't count the number of times he became broke and penniless following a highly successful venture gone sour. His personal life was as spotted as his financial life and a recounting of that could easily consume a full book.

I would have thought that my discovery of his many flaws would cause me to lose respect for him, and thus doubt the veracity of his teachings that have influenced me for more than twenty years. But it is quite the opposite. Having listened to the struggles of this very human man has given me a whole new perspective of respect, even awe, of the incredible resilience and persistence that he displayed repeatedly against sometimes massive odds.

I now understand that he didn't write about some theory of how to think and grow rich. He wrote from experience his numerous experiences and the experiences of America's most successful.

While the casual observer would believe that this book is only about making money, those of us who have studied it for years know otherwise. It's about a better way to live a rich life. And for that I am grateful that Napoleon gave so much of himself in order that he might leave us with this incredible work.

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